Initial exploration of Claude CLI by Jolly Gupta 27-Feb-2026

What is Claude Code?

Claude Code is a **CLI-based AI coding assistant** built by Anthropic for developers.

(**CLI means Command Line Interface** It is a way to interact with a computer by **typing commands** instead of clicking buttons.)

It allows you to:

- Work with code inside your **terminal**
- Ask Claude to **write, edit, refactor, debug**
- Understand entire codebases
- Run commands and suggest fixes
- Help manage multi-file projects

So yes ✔
It is designed for **developers who are comfortable using a terminal**.

How It Actually Works (Conceptually)

Think of it like this:

You + Terminal + Claude AI

Instead of going to a website chat UI,
you interact with Claude **directly from your project folder**.

Why It's Different from Normal Chat

Normal Chat:

- You copy-paste code
- Limited context

Claude Code:

- Has **direct access to your project files**
- Understands folder structure
- Can modify multiple files
- Works more like a real coding assistant

Is It Only for Expert Developers?

Not necessarily — but:

You should be comfortable with:

- Terminal commands
- Git basics
- Project structure
- Running local environments

Full Setup Guide – Claude Code (CLI)

⚠ You need:

- Node.js (v18+ recommended) It lets you run JavaScript outside the browser.
- Terminal knowledge
- An Anthropic API key

  Check if Node is installed:
  `node -v`
  If not installed:
  Download from:
  👉 https://nodejs.org ------- I already installed it
  Install LTS version.
  Verify:

  ```
  node -v
  npm -v
  ```

Correct Flow

Step 1

Check Node:

node -v

Step 2

Install Claude:

npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code

install = download package

-g = install globally (usable everywhere)

@anthropic-ai/claude-code = package name

npm = Node Package Manager

It comes with **Node.js**.

It is used to:

- Install libraries
- Install tools
- Manage JavaScript packages
- Install CLI tools (like claude

Immediately test:

claude --version

👉 If It Works

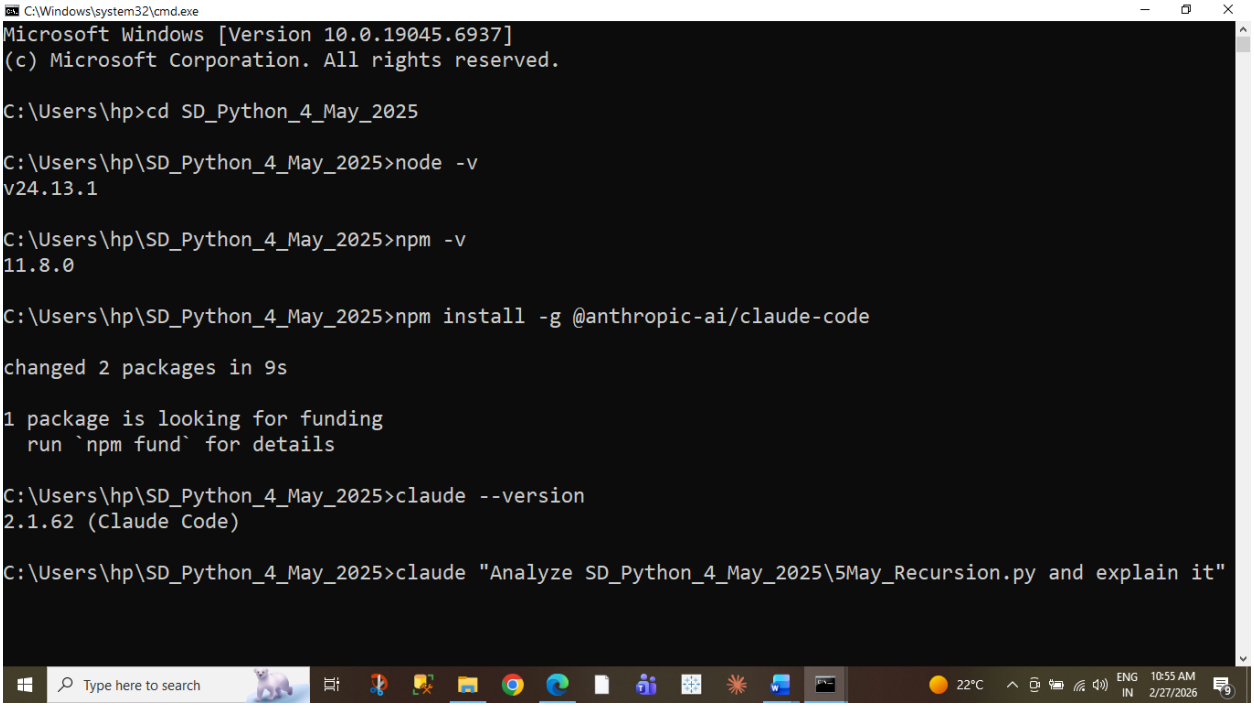
You can directly go to **Step 4**:

Case-1 One Folder-> 1 file

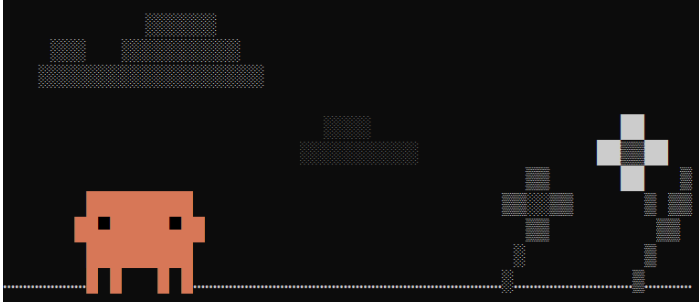
cd C:\Users\hp\math-helper
claude "Optimize performance in this project"

Case-2 Multiple Files in One Folder

claude "Analyze math-helper\app.py and explain it"

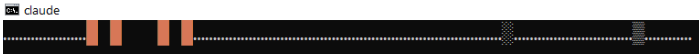


```
claude
2.1.62 (Claude Code)

C:\Users\hp\SD_Python_4_May_2025>claude "Analyze SD_Python_4_May_2025\5May_Recursion.py and explain it"

Welcome to Claude Code v2.1.62
```

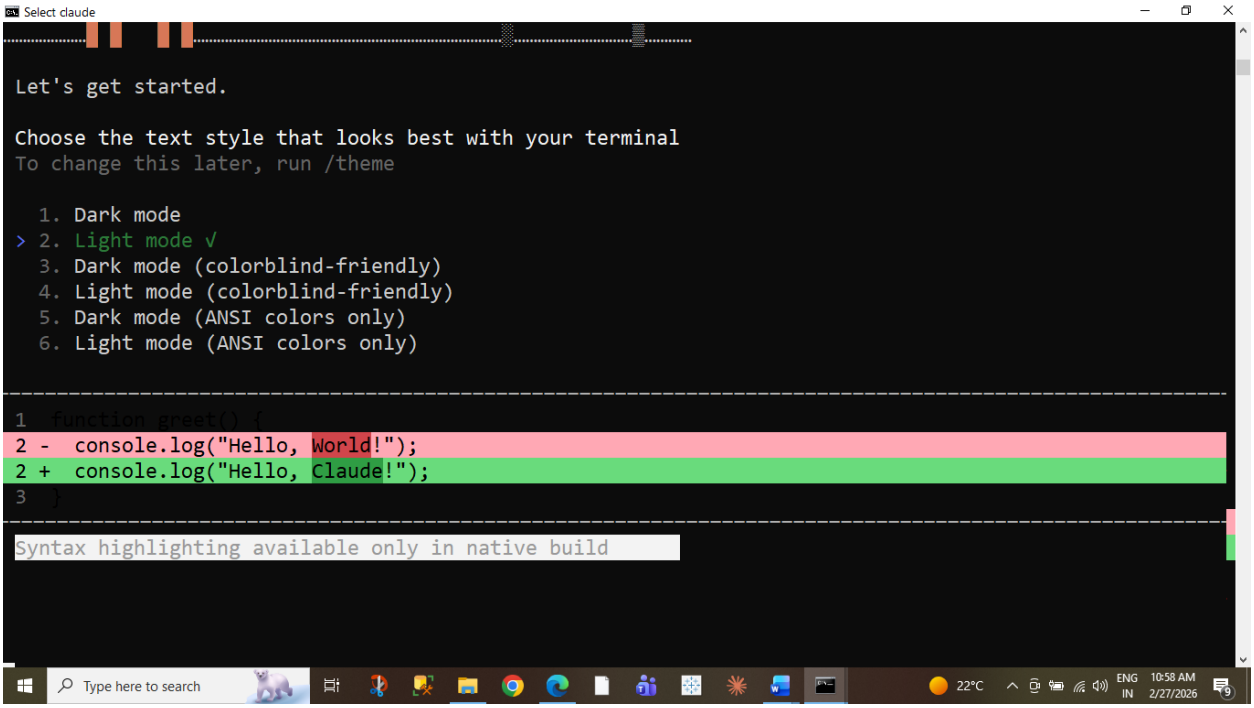


```
Let's get started.

Choose the text style that looks best with your terminal
To change this later, run /theme
```

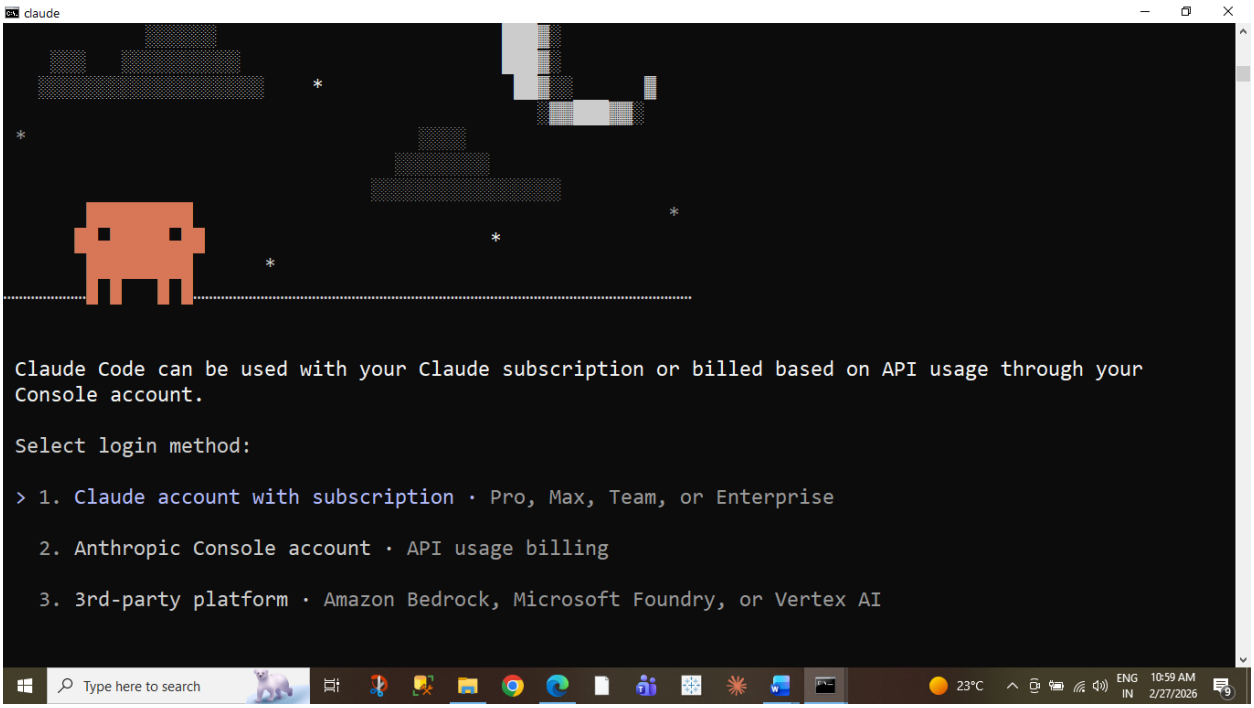
```
claude
```



```
Let's get started.

Choose the text style that looks best with your terminal
To change this later, run /theme

  1. Dark mode
> 2. Light mode ✓
  3. Dark mode (colorblind-friendly)
  4. Light mode (colorblind-friendly)
  5. Dark mode (ANSI colors only)
  6. Light mode (ANSI colors only)

1  function greet() {
2 -  console.log("Hello, World!");
2 +  console.log("Hello, Claude!");
3  }

Syntax highlighting available only in native build
Welcome to Claude Code v2.1.62
```



Press any from 1-6



You may choose any appropriate subscription plan to analyze the code using Claude Code. However, if purchasing a plan is not possible, you can copy and paste the code into claude.ai or upload the file directly, and it will still analyze your code.